Mozilla CEO Cries Over Apple Auto-update

John Lilly, CEO of Mozilla says Apple's latest decision to bundle their Safari browser with Apple auto-update is unethical. Lilly claims this move causes the customer to download software unawares. His opinions are met with mixed reactions throughout the industry.

Glasses For The Absent-minded

Japanese researchers at the Tokyo University School of Information Science have developed glasses fitted with a camera. Aimed at amnesiacs, the camera scans the regions you view as you travel around, and help you get to the place later.

Enter

Gavin Watson
Director–Asia Pacific, Corel

Corel's setting up shop in India, and we caught up with Gavin Watson to talk about Corel's plans for our fabled land

What do you aim to accomplish with your presence in India?
Firstly, and most importantly, we intend to create awareness about Corel and our product line-up. In addition, we aim to strengthen our software distribution channel to give potential customers greater access to our products. We also have a number of non-compliant users *(read pirates)* of Corel software here—we want to convert them into compliant users too.

How do you plan on doing that?
Throw them all in jail! *(laughs)* But on a serious note, we want to do so with awareness. We plan on getting people exposed to, and learn our software through training institutes, and once they start earning from their training, we hope they'll invest in the software for their professional use.

Have you tied up with anyone to provide education?
Yes, we have tied up with a number of training centres to provide courses on Corel software. In addition, some state governments have added CorelDRAW to their syllabi as well. Finally, there's the Corel Academy in Chennai, which will train students in our software.

How will Corel Users in India avail of software support?
The first line of support will be your reseller, followed by Corel Sales and online support. We also have a tech support centre in Manila. Finally, there's the CorelDRAW community, which has a number of active Indian users. Increasingly, we're finding that more people are turning to the community for solutions to their problems. Users identify with each other, and solutions sometimes come faster than even tech support!

FALLEN ANGEL

Thai Monks Told To Stick To Monking

Of late, Thai officials have been urging Buddhist monks to avoid using social networking sites to woo women. This comes after a social advocacy group found this to be the best past time for many Buddhist monks. All the hype around this story comes on the heels of alleged rape allegations by a teenager from north-eastern Thailand. The police have since arrested a 23-year-old monk. It is alleged that the monk befriended the teenager on Hi5 and then lured her to meet him in his room, where he apparently tried to rape her.

Jakrapob Penkair, a junior minister, in an official statement urged Hi5 users to tell the monks to leave the site if they were using it. It seems that Thailand, known for high rate of prostitution, intends to improve its image internationally. In fact, reports of monks being caught either using or selling drugs or even having consensual sex with women are not met with surprise in the Thai media.

A senior Culture Ministry official, however, said monks should not be banned from cyberspace. Nevertheless, he added that the monks should consider these moments of "crisis", and rather spread the teachings of Buddha to the young. Ladda Thangsupachai, head of the Cultural Surveillance Centre, said, "Instead of using the Net to flirt with young girls, monks should find ways to preach Dharma and lead them in the right direction."

After all, it is generally said, everything has a plus and minus factor attached to it. Some use social networking for constructive purposes, while there are some that use it wrongfully. Either way, policing and moderation is needed at times to maintain the balance.

I BEAT M

IBM, Allies Offer Microsoft-free PCs For Eastern Europe

It has been reported that IBM has partnered with companies in Austria and Poland to offer Microsoft-free PCs for the eastern European market. According to an official IBM statement, the PCs will include IBM's Lotus Symphony software based on the Open Document Format, which is a rival to Microsoft's Office Open XML. In recent times, Microsoft has been trying to push for Open XML as an internationally approved standard. IBM Corp said in its statement that it was offering the PCs based on the open source Linux operating system together with Red Hat software distributor VDEL of Austria, and Polish distributor and services firm LX Polska in response to demand from Russian IT chiefs. Russia, with rapid infrastructure growth has many large corporations and public-service organisations that are now in the process of building large computer systems, and is fast emerging as a key battleground between Microsoft and rivals offering open-source alternatives.

IBM, which had earlier sold its PC business to China's Lenovo, said that partners of VDEL and LX Polska would make the hardware for the PCs. IBM said the Linux PC line christened 'Open Referent' that it would offer with these partners, would cut desktop computing costs by nearly half for buyers. It said CIOs from Russian organisations, including the Ministry of Defence, airline Aeroflot and the private Alfa Bank, among several others, have requested an open-source PC.

In this Microsoft dominant market, every other company seems to come up with an alternative to Microsoft's products. Initially, it was Google with their online office suite, then the Open source movement. Now, PCs already coming pre-loaded with Linux seem to be yet another blow for Microsoft.

Security Watch

MS Excel Vulnerabilities

The Problem
After studying reported problems, Microsoft has admitted that a vulnerability in MS Excel could allow remote execution of harmful code. As per the official release by Microsoft, an attacker could take complete control of a system by successfully exploiting these vulnerabilities, through a specially crafted Excel sheet. Once, the attacker manages to send the corrupted file to the intended prey, he / she can install programs, create new accounts with full user rights or even view or modify data on the system. This security update is labelled as Critical for Microsoft Office Excel 2000 SP 3 and rated Important for subsequent versions of Excel.

The Solution
Patches specific to the version of MS Excel are available on Microsoft's Web site. Go to **http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/ms08-014.mspx** and download the patch available according to the MS Excel version you are using. If you do not find your version, chances are that you are not affected.

GLOBAL OUTSOURCING

India Losing Its Offshoring Advantage

According to the latest analysis of the Indian labour market by Pierre Audoin Consultants (PAC), out of the 21 centres opened since January 2007 by the 20 largest UK companies, only two were in India, while four were in China, three in Eastern Europe and Morocco, respectively. Nick Mayes, senior consultant at PAC said that in the short term, there was no "serious threat" to India's outsourcing dominance. However, he added that companies are on the verge of reducing their dependence on "India's heated labour market".

China's emergence as a global sourcing hub has traditionally been slow but the report found that BT Global Services, EDS, IBM and Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) have all started sourcing facilities in the country over the past 18 months.

The two facilities launched in India were both outside the traditional

HOT

Quad-core Goes Affordable

You've got to hand it to Intel for this: we'd never have thought that we could have four whole cores on our desktops, and still have money left over to buy food and clothes!

NOT

So?

Precisely. Unless you use 3D or math-intensive applications a lot, chances are you're not going to be able to tell the difference between two and four cores. Even games have been slow to exploit all that extra processing power, but hey, at least they've *started*.

Opinion Poll

Which feature of newer cellphones appeal to you the most
(You, too, can participate in this poll—at **www.thinkdigit.com**)

A Large screens or Touch function
B Good music quality and storage capacity
C Video playback
D Digicam quality cameras

Users upgrade their phones often and rather want a device offering the maximum. My next phone should have at least 16M colour, GPS, WiFi, Expandable Memory, 3rd party applications and excellent image capturing with crisp and DVD quality Video capturing.

Yash Maheshwari
Pune

I'd go for option A large screens or touch function. Reason—Large screen and touch functions are of great help when I am on the move as I can check email, browse Web sites and do everything a business phone can in a better way.

Dinkar Mohana Pai
Kochi

(d) All the above options are already available in the market, at cheap rates. So giving customers a camera with digicam resolutions is an nice option to get rid of carrying digi or handycams, which is too hard to handle.

Milan P. Chouhan
Baroda

I love music and have a huge collection in my PC. Phones should have greater storage capacity so one can store as many high quality songs and videos possible. And also better quality of music is absolutely necessary.

Shoban Kumar
Thiruvananthapuram

(b) Good music quality and storage capacity. A cell phone is supposed to be multi-functional. Prevent the need to carry multiple gadgets. My cell phone should play music all day long with large memory.

Ashish Rohilla (Keith)
New Delhi

I choose D—Digicam quality cameras. I prefer digicam quality cameras, avoiding the need for digital cameras or video camera with a mobile. Hence one phone serves both the purpose, for communication and digital imaging.

Channabasanna S
Bengaluru

(You, too, can participate in this poll—at **www.thinkdigit.com**)

■ Mash Maker, a mashup creation tool launched by Intel ■ Sony tries to charge $50 for removal of bloatware, retracts fee after massive protests ■

■ Cuba lifts ban on sale of computers, DVD players, 20 inch TVs ■ Microsoft chops Vista retail prices ■